

Feeling of Knowing Forecast Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and the Knower • 20-30 min

Category	Knowledge and the Knower	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Easy	ID	feeling-of-knowing-forecast

Big idea: The feeling that knowledge is available is itself a judgement that can be tested.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students predict which forgotten answers they would recognize later, then test the reliability of that feeling.

Student Prompt

Inspect Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Recall prompt: What is the term for a word that imitates a sound?. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Recognition options later: metaphor, onomatopoeia, alliteration, oxymoron. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Feeling of Knowing Forecast Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Recognition options later: metaphor, onomatopoeia, alliteration, oxymoron. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — The feeling that knowledge is available is itself a judgement that can be tested.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Feeling of Knowing Forecast Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	How reliable is introspection as evidence about what we know?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Knowledge and the Knower.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how the feeling that knowledge is available is itself a judgement that can be tested.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: How reliable is introspection as evidence about what we know?

Setup Checklist

- Use questions students might plausibly know but may not immediately retrieve.
- Make students forecast recognition before seeing options so the metacognitive judgement is visible.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- Recall prompt: What is the term for a word that imitates a sound?
- Recognition options later: metaphor, onomatopoeia, alliteration, oxymoron.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/feeling-of-knowing-forecast/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/feeling-of-knowing-forecast/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/feeling-of-knowing-forecast/visual-prompt.svg>
- Forecast table with columns: no recall, feeling-of-knowing rating, recognition answer, outcome.
- Class tally comparing high forecast items and actual recognition success.

Run Sequence

1. Ask students to answer short recall questions without options.
2. For unanswered items, students rate whether they would recognize the answer later.
3. Give multiple-choice options for those same items.
4. Students compare feeling-of-knowing forecasts with recognition accuracy.
5. Discuss whether introspection is evidence and when it needs checking.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: How reliable is introspection as evidence about what we know?
- What is the difference between not knowing and not retrieving?

- When should a knower trust a feeling of familiarity?

Teacher Quick Script

- A feeling of knowing is useful data, but it is not the same as knowing.
- What kind of evidence could confirm or challenge your feeling of familiarity?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...